

Scripture Truthfulness

doc-scripture-truthfulness

Bibliology · Inerrancy · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus applies

Statement under examination

Scripture is true and trustworthy in all that it affirms.

In plain language

Across both Testaments the Scriptures speak about themselves with consistent vocabulary, and a direct query of the canon confirms the pattern is dense and widespread rather than a few proof texts. In the Old Testament the Hebrew word "truth, firmness, reliability" (emet), which the query counts at over a hundred occurrences, is applied to God's word in Psalm 119:160, where "the head or sum of your word is truth". The same psalm says "all your commandments are faithfulness" (Psalm 119:86), using the related word "faithfulness or reliability" (emunah), and Psalm 111:7 pairs "truth" (emet) with "all his precepts". Proverbs 30:5 says "every utterance of God is refined" (using tsaraph), a metal-smelting image of silver tested until the dross is gone, the same image as Psalm 12:6. Numbers 23:19 says "God is not a man that he should lie" (using kazav, the lie-verb). In the New Testament Jesus says in John 17:17 "your word is truth" (aletheia), and the Greek places "truth" in the predicate slot of the linking verb 'is' (the copula), which makes it an identification, not just a description. In John 10:35 he says Scripture "cannot be broken" (dunamai negated plus the passive infinitive luthenai of luo), where the grammar ('cannot' plus a passive infinitive) states a flat impossibility, not a maybe. In Matthew 22:31-32 he settles a dispute about resurrection by leaning on the present tense of one verb in Exodus 3:6, "I am" (ego eimi), treating even the exact form of the words as reliable. Paul in Titus 1:2 calls God "non-lying or unable to lie" (apseudes), a word that occurs only once in the whole canon (a hapax) and is built to mean "unable to lie", and rests the promise of eternal life on that fact. This stack runs through Torah, Wisdom, the Psalms, the Gospels, and a letter without contradiction, so the property that Scripture is true is affirmed strongly. Where readers diverge is not over whether Scripture is true but over two things the words leave open: the truth-word itself can mean both moral faithfulness and factual accuracy, and the canon uses it in both senses, so people weigh those differently; and the phrase "in all that it affirms" does not by itself say how far the truthfulness reaches into incidental detail. The vocabulary settles the property and leaves the precise scope to be argued, which is exactly where honest readers part ways. Texts sometimes raised as problems, such as 1 Kings 22, Ezekiel 14:9, Jeremiah 20:7, and 2 Thessalonians 2:11, on inspection place the deceptive content in spirits, prophets, or people chosen for delusion in judgment, never in God's own speech, so they sit alongside the pattern rather than against it.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0410	אל	el	God	
H0433	אלוה	eloah	god	
H0529	אמן	emun	faithful	
H0530	אמונה	emunah	faithfulness	35
H0539	אמן	aman	be faithful	102

H0565	אִמְרָה	imrah	word	34
H0571	אֱמֶת	emeth	truth	108
H1697	דָּבָר	dabar	word	1,368
H2889	טָהוֹר	tahor	pure	89
H3576	כָּזַב	kazav	to lie	14
H3605	כֹּל	kol	all	5,049
H4687	מִצְוָה	mitsvah	commandment	
H5162	נָחַם	nacham	to be sorry	
H5713	עֵדוּת	edah	witness	
H5769	עוֹלָם	olam	forever	
H6664	צֶדֶק	tsedeq	righteousness	
H6884	צָרַח	tsaraph	to refine	30
H8267	שֶׁקֶר	sheqer	deception	
H8451	תּוֹרָה	torah	instruction	
H8549	תָּמִים	tamim	unblemished	
G0037	ἁγιάζω	hagiazō	to sanctify	29
G0225	ἀλήθεια	aletheia	truth	110
G0226	ἀληθεύω	alētheuō	be truthful	
G0227	ἀληθής	alethes	true	26
G0228	ἀληθινός	alēthinos	true	
G0230	ἀληθῶς	alēthōs	truly	
G0893	ἄψευδής	apseudes	not a liar	1
G1124	γραφή	graphe	a writing	51
G1410	δύναμαι	dunamai	be able	211
G1411	δύναμις	dunamis	power	120
G1510	εἰμι	eimi	to be	
G1861	ἐπαγγέλλομαι	epangellō	to profess	
G2198	ζάω	zaō	to live	
G2316	θεός	theos	God	
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	339
G3089	λύω	luo	to loose	44
G3498	νεκρός	nekros	dead	
G3756	οὐ	ou	no	
G4105	πλανάω	planaō	to lead astray	40
G5571	ψευδής	pseudēs	false	
G5579	ψεῦδος	pseudos	lie	10

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The lexical pattern is dense, spread across the whole Bible (pan-canonical), and converging. In queried canon data the Hebrew truth root "to be firm or reliable" (אמן, aman) surfaces as "truth or firmness" (אֱמֶת, emeth) at 108 token occurrences across 106 verses, predicated of God's word in Psalm 119:160 (רֹאשׁ דְּבָרְךָ אֱמֶת, "the head or sum of your word is truth", with the truth-word as a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement, that is, a predicate noun tagged HNcfsa), and predicated of His works and precepts in Psalm 111:7. The cognate noun "faithfulness or reliability" (אֱמוּנָה, emunah) at 35 occurrences carries the same statement in Psalm 119:86 under the all-inclusive quantifier "all or every" (כָּל; kol). The speech-purity image binds "utterance or saying" (אִמְרָה, imrah) at 34 occurrences to the metallurgical verb "to refine in a crucible" (צָרַף, tsaraph) in Proverbs 30:5 and Psalm 12:6. On the Greek side "truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) at 110 occurrences across 99 verses stands without the article 'the' (anarthrous) in the predicate slot of the linking verb 'is' (the copula) in John 17:17 (ὁ λόγος ὁ σὸς ἀλήθειά ἐστιν, "your word is truth"), an identification not a mere attribute. John 10:35 negates "to be able" (δύναμαι, dunamai) with the completed-past passive infinitive "to be loosed or annulled" (λυθῆναι, luthenai, from λύω, luo), a categorical impossibility that Scripture be broken. Titus 1:2 grounds promise in ὁ ἀψευδὴς θεός, "the non-lying God", where "non-lying or unable to lie" (ἄψευδής, apseudes) is a queried hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible, here only in Titus 1:2), an alpha-privative essential predicate (a 'not-X' adjective that names an essential property of the subject). Matthew 22:32 hangs a doctrine on the present-tense linking verb "I am" (Ἐγώ εἰμι, ego eimi). The stack crosses Torah, Wisdom, Psalter, Synoptic and Johannine Gospels, and a Pastoral Epistle without internal contradiction, so the property is decisively affirmed. Divergence is not over whether Scripture is true but over the sense and scope the words leave open, addressed below.

Scripture

Ps.119.160 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H0571 אֱמֶת, H1697 דְּבָרְךָ; H3605 כָּל; H5769 עֲלָם, H6664 יָדְךָ.

Reasoning. Psalm 119:160 says רֹאשׁ דְּבָרְךָ אֱמֶת, "the head or sum of your word is truth", assigning "truth or firmness" (אֱמֶת, emeth) as the noun completing the 'X is Y' statement (a predicate nominative, in the form queried as a feminine singular absolute noun, HNcfsa) to "the head or sum of your word" (רֹאשׁ דְּבָרְךָ, rosh devarkha). The two cola stand in Hebrew poetic parallelism (matched line pairs), which the figures enum does not encode: the first colon binds "head-of-word" to "truth", and the parallel colon binds "every ordinance of your righteousness" (יְצִדְקֶךָ, kol mishpat tsidqekha) to "forever" (לְעֹלָם, le-olam). The all-inclusive quantifier "all or every" (כָּל; kol) plus "truth" (אֱמֶת, emeth) plus "forever" (עֲלָם, olam) yields a categorical claim of total, enduring truthfulness for the divine word. The "to be firm" (אמן, aman) root here carries both reliability and correspondence senses attested elsewhere in the same lemma.

Ps.111.7 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H0571 אֱמֶת, H0539 אֱמָן, H3605 כָּל.

Reasoning. Psalm 111:7 reads מְעֹשֵׂי יְדֵי אֱמֶת וּמִשְׁפָּט נְאֻמִּים: כָּל פִּקְּדוֹנָיו, "the works of his hands are truth and judgment, all his precepts are reliable". It predicates "truth or firmness" (אֱמֶת, emeth) of the works of His hands, and predicates "are made firm or are reliable" (נְאֻמִּים, ne'emanim, the Hebrew passive form, that is, the niph'al participle, of the root אמן, aman, the same family as אֱמֶת, emeth) of "all his precepts" (כָּל פִּקְּדוֹנָיו, kol piqqudayv). This verse, queried as a direct neighbor of the Psalm 119 cluster, pairs the truth-root simultaneously with God's acts and with the universally quantified body of His precepts, showing that the same vocabulary spans deed and verbal instruction.

Prov.30.5 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: metaphor

Key terms. H3605 כל; H0565 אַמְרָה, H0433 אֱלֹהִים, H6884 צָרַף.

Reasoning. Proverbs 30:5 reads כָּל אֱמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים צֻנְפָה, "every utterance of God is refined". The metallurgical verb "to refine in a crucible" (צָרַף, tsaraph), meaning "refined, tested in the crucible until no dross remains", is queried here as a simple active form of the Hebrew verb in passive participle (the qal passive participle, the simple-form past participle). It is predicated by "all or every" (כָּל; kol) of every utterance of God. "Utterance or saying" (אֱמָרָה, imrah) appears here in the construct (joined) form queried as H0565A, HNcfsc (a feminine singular construct noun). The figure transfers smelting-purity to divine speech. The second colon, מִגֵּן הוּא לְתֹסִים בּוֹ, "He is a shield to those who take refuge in him", shifts from the property of the word to its function for those who trust it, grounding practical refuge on the tested purity of the word.

Ps.12.6 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: metaphor, hyperbole

Key terms. H0565 אַמְרָה, H2889 טָהַר, H6884 צָרַף.

Reasoning. Psalm 12:6 reads אֱמָרוֹת יְהוָה אֱמָרוֹת טָהוֹרוֹת, "the utterances of YHWH are pure utterances", silver "refined" (צָרַף, tsaraph) in a furnace of earth, purified sevenfold. The same lemma pair as Proverbs 30:5 ("utterance", אֱמָרָה, imrah, plus "refine", צָרַף, tsaraph) recurs with the metallurgical figure intensified by the sevenfold hyperbole. The trope is stable across Psalter and Proverbs, establishing the speech-purity statement in more than one canon book.

Ps.119.86 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3605 כל; H4687 מַצֵּה, H0530 אֱמוּנָה.

Reasoning. Psalm 119:86 reads כָּל מִצְוֹתֶיךָ אֱמוּנָה, "all your commandments are faithfulness or reliability". "Faithfulness or reliability" (אֱמוּנָה, emunah, root אָמַן, aman, at 35 queried occurrences) is the cognate noun complement to "truth or firmness" (אֱמֶת, emeth) in Psalm 119:160 and Psalm 111:7. The all-inclusive quantifier "all or every" (כָּל; kol) recurs, producing a categorical statement and confirming that the truth-root is applied to the whole body of divine commandment, not a sample.

Ps.93.5 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H5713 עֵדוּת, H0539 אָמַן.

Reasoning. Psalm 93:5 reads עֵדֹתֶיךָ נֶאֱמָנוּ מְאֹד, "your testimonies are very faithful or sure". The Hebrew passive form (the niph'al) of "to be firm" (אָמַן, aman, the verbal root behind "truth", אֱמֶת, emeth, and "faithfulness", אֱמוּנָה, emunah, queried at 102 occurrences) is predicated of God's "testimony" (עֵדוּת, eduth). This is the same root family that the Greek "truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) of John 17:17 and the "non-lying" (ἄψευδής, apseudes) of Titus 1:2 semantically intersect, tying the Hebrew and Greek witnesses through a shared semantic field.

Num.23.19 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H0410 אֵל, H3576 קָזַב, H5162 נָחַם.

Reasoning. Numbers 23:19 reads לֹא אִישׁ אֵל וַיִּקְזַב, "God is not a man that he should lie" ("to lie or deceive", קָזַב, kazav, queried at 14 occurrences, a rare verb). The verse is the Hebrew counterpart to the Greek "non-lying God" (ἄψευδής, apseudes) of Titus 1:2: "to lie" (קָזַב, kazav) is negated of God and paired with rhetorical denials, said and not do, fulfilling and not fulfilling (וְלֹא יִקְיֶמְנָה). The negation of the lie-verb plus the affirmation that God performs his spoken word secures divine speech as non-deceptive and reliable in fulfillment.

John.17.17 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0037 ἀγιάζω, G0225 ἀλήθεια, G3056 λόγος

Reasoning. John 17:17 reads ἀγιάσον αὐτοὺς ἐν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ· ὁ λόγος ὁ σὸς ἀλήθειά ἐστιν, "sanctify them in the truth; your word is truth". The second clause is an identification through a linking verb (a copular predicate-nominative, that is, a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement): "the word" (ὁ λόγος, ho logos) is the subject with the article 'the', "truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) is the predicate without the article 'the' (anarthrous), and "is" (ἐστιν, estin) is the linking verb. "Truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) without the article 'the' in the predicate slot assigns the quality of truth essentially, not merely incidentally, to the Father's word. The prayer rests on the means of sanctification being itself truth. "Truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) is queried at 110 occurrences across 99 verses, a stable high-frequency term.

John.10.35 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1124 γραφή, G3756 οὐ, G1410 δύναμαι, G3089 λύω

Reasoning. John 10:35 reads καὶ οὐ δύναται λυθῆναι ἡ γραφή, "and the Scripture cannot be broken". The parenthetical pairs the negated verb "to be able" (δύναμαι, dunamai) with the completed-past passive infinitive "to be loosed or annulled" (λυθῆναι, luthenai, from λύω, luo, "to loose or annul"), a categorical modal impossibility (a 'cannot ever' statement) rather than a contingent failure. "The writing or Scripture" (ἡ γραφή, he graphe) with the article 'the' denotes the written corpus as a unit. Jesus argues from a single word in Psalm 82:6 and grounds the argument on Scripture's non-breakability, treating the written text as binding at the level of its wording.

Matt.22.29 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4105 πλανάω, G1124 γραφή, G1411 δύναμις, G2316 θεός

Reasoning. Matthew 22:29 reads Πλανᾶσθε μὴ εἰδότες τὰς γραφὰς μηδὲ τὴν δύναμιν τοῦ θεοῦ, "you are deceived, not knowing the Scriptures nor the power of God". The Sadducees' error ("to lead astray", πλανάω, planao, here in the ongoing simple-statement present indicative form, that is, an ongoing being led astray) is diagnosed as ignorance of "the writings" (τὰς γραφὰς, tas graphas), the writings in the plural. Knowing the Scriptures is set as the corrective to doctrinal error, which presupposes the Scriptures' reliability as the fixed standard against which error is measured.

Matt.22.31-32 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1510 εἰμι, G2316 θεός, G3498 νεκρός, G2198 ζάω

Reasoning. Jesus' resurrection argument in Matthew 22:31-32 from Exodus 3:6 hinges on the present tense of the linking verb 'is': "I am" (Εγώ εἰμι, ego eimi) "the God of Abraham" (ὁ θεὸς Ἀβραάμ, ho theos Abraam). The patriarchs being long dead, yet God identifying himself in the present as their God, joined to the axiom οὐκ ἔστιν ὁ θεὸς νεκρῶν ἀλλὰ ζώντων, "he is not God of the dead but of the living", yields the conclusion. The argument is intelligible only if the precise verbal form of the Old Testament text is trusted down to its tense, a strong implicit witness to textual truthfulness at the granular level.

Titus.1.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0893 ἀψευδής, G2316 θεός, G1861 ἐπαγγέλλομαι

Reasoning. Titus 1:2 reads ἐπ' ἐλπίδι ζωῆς αἰωνίου, ἣν ἐπηγγέλατο ὁ ἀψευδὴς θεός, "in hope of eternal life, which the non-lying God promised". "Non-lying or unable to lie" (ἀψευδής, apseudes) is queried as a true hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible, here only in Titus 1:2), formed with the alpha-privative prefix (the 'not-X' prefix) on "lie" (ψεῦδος, pseudos). As an attributive adjective it makes "incapacity-to-lie" an essential predicate (a defining attribute) of God. Because the term occurs only once, its sense is read off its transparent word-form and its near-synonym field ("lie", ψεῦδος, pseudos, and "false", ψευδής, pseudes) rather than triangulated across occurrences. The promise's reliability is grounded in the speaker's nature: if God cannot lie, his recorded promise cannot deceive.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Matt.22.32	Exod.3.6	tsk	1
Titus.1.2	Num.23.19	tsk	1
Prov.30.5	Ps.12.6	tsk	1
Ps.19.7	Ps.93.5	tsk	1
Ps.119.160	Ps.119.86	tsk	1
Ps.119.160	Ps.119.75	tsk	1
Ps.19.7	Ps.111.7	tsk	1
Ps.19.7	Ps.18.30	tsk	1
John.17.17	John.8.40	tsk	1

Complicating texts

1Kgs.22.22-23 · addressed

1 Kings 22:22-23: YHWH sends a lying spirit ("spirit of falsehood", רוח שקר, ruach sheqer) into Ahab's prophets. The text reports divine sovereignty over a deceptive prophetic agent, but the lemma "falsehood or lie" (שקר, sheqer, queried at 102 occurrences) attaches to the spirit and the false prophets, never to YHWH's own "word" (דבר; dabar). In the same chapter YHWH's word through Micaiah accurately predicts Ahab's death, so the truth-statement on God's own speech is preserved while the falsehood is located in the agents.

Ezek.14.9 · addressed

Ezekiel 14:9 reads אֲנִי יְהוָה פָּתִיתִי יָאֵל, "I YHWH have enticed that prophet". The Hebrew intensive form (the piel) of "to entice or persuade" (פתה, pathah) here is judicial: God ratifies the chosen self-deception of an idolatrous inquirer and his complicit prophet. The genre is judgment oracle and the action falls on those who have already rejected YHWH's true word. The verse specifies that divine judgment may consist in confirming a chosen lie, with deceiver and inquirer both bearing guilt, and does not retract the non-deception statement of Numbers 23:19 or Titus 1:2.

Jer.20.7 · addressed

Jeremiah 20:7 reads פָּתִיתִנִי יְהוָה וְאַפְתָּ, "you persuaded or enticed me, YHWH, and I was persuaded". The verb "to entice or persuade" (פתה, pathah) carries an attested polysemy (multiple senses) across persuade, entice, and deceive; in the prophetic-complaint genre Jeremiah voices the subjective experience of overwhelming prophetic compulsion, paired in the next verse with fire in his bones. The lemma is shared with persuasion and seduction texts, so reading it as a charge of false content over-presses the lament register. The verse does not assert falsehood in YHWH's word.

2Thess.2.11 · addressed

2 Thessalonians 2:11 reads πέμπει αὐτοῖς ὁ θεὸς ἐνέργειαν πλάνης εἰς τὸ πιστεῦσαι αὐτοὺς τῷ ψεύδει, "God sends them an active power of deception so that they believe the lie". God sends an active power of delusion to those who refused to love the truth. The structure parallels Ezekiel 14:9: judicial ratification of chosen unbelief. The object of belief is "the lie" (τὸ ψεῦδος, to pseudos) they preferred ("lie", ψεῦδος, pseudos, queried at 10 occurrences), not a divine utterance. The "non-lying" (ἀψεудής, apseudes) statement of Titus 1:2 stands intact because the falsehood is the recipients' preference, not God's speech.

Gen.2.17 · addressed

Genesis 2:17 is sometimes raised as whether Adam died on the day he ate. The Hebrew uses the doubled-verb emphasis construction (the infinitive absolute) מוֹת־תָּמוּת, mot tamut, "dying you shall die", and the phrase "in the day" (בַּיּוֹם; be-yom) can function idiomatically as "when" rather than "within a single calendar day". The narrative reports immediate rupture and expulsion and later physical death. The lexical particulars, the doubled-verb construction (the infinitive absolute) and the idiomatic "in the day" (בַּיּוֹם; be-yom), leave the statement standing rather than falsified, so it does not count against the truthfulness statement.

Deut.22.20 · addressed

Deuteronomy 22:20 is not a contradiction but a sense-disambiguating witness. Here "truth" (אֱמֶת, emeth) is used forensically of a factual matter, "if the thing is אֱמֶת (emeth)", that is, if it is factually so, paralleling Deuteronomy 17:4 and 1 Kings 10:6. This confirms by query that the same "truth" (אֱמֶת, emeth) lemma predicated of God's word in Psalm 119:160 carries a correspondence-to-fact sense and not only relational faithfulness, which is why the proposition can be read as factual truthfulness and not merely covenant loyalty. It is listed as complicating only in that it bears on the scope and sense question, and it resolves toward, not against, the verdict.

Concordance traversed

H0571, H0530, H0539, H0529, H0565, H1697, H8451, H6884, H2889, H8549, H3576, H8267, H5162, H3605, G0225, G0226, G0227, G0228, G0230, G0893, G5579, G5571, G1124, G3056, G3089, G4105, G1410, G1411, G0037, G1861, G2316

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The bundle reports not_in_ecm_scope true and supplied zero variant units for the cited verses. A direct query of the ingested ECM window (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants window, 116 VariantUnit nodes, the 3 John 1:1 to 1:15 sample) confirmed that none of the anchor verses (John 17:17, John 10:35, Matthew 22:29-32, Titus 1:2) fall within the ECM scope, so ecm_status is n/a rather than ecm-shadow. The load-bearing readings were checked against the queried Greek text: John 17:17 ὁ λόγος ὁ σὸς ἀλήθειά ἐστιν ("your word is truth"), John 10:35 οὐ δύναται λυθῆναι ἡ γραφή ("the Scripture cannot be broken"), Titus 1:2 ὁ ἀψευδὴς θεός ("the non-lying God"), and Matthew 22:32 Ἐγὼ εἰμι ("I am") are textually stable in the editions ingested. The Hebrew anchors rest on the Leningrad-based OSHB (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible) token stream. No variant materially affects the verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. grammatico-historical, analogia-scripturae

analogia scripturae invoked

truthfulness as moral faithfulness (אָמֵן root, relational reliability): affirms · Reads "truth" (אֱמֶת, emeth), "faithfulness" (אֱמוּנָה, emunah), and the Hebrew passive form (the niphal) of "to be firm" (אָמַן, aman) primarily in their relational sense of firmness, trustworthiness, and covenant reliability, and reads "truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) as the dependable self-disclosure of God. On this lens the proposition is affirmed in its strongest form: God's word will not fail those who trust it, exactly as Proverbs 30:5 grounds refuge on the tested word. This reading is well supported lexically because the "to be firm" (אָמַן, aman) family demonstrably carries the faithfulness sense in many queried occurrences.

truthfulness as correspondence to fact (forensic and factual accuracy): affirms · Reads the same "truth" (אֱמֶת, emeth) lemma in its attested forensic sense, "the thing is true", that is, factually so, as queried in Deuteronomy 17:4, Deuteronomy 22:20, and 1 Kings 10:6, and takes John 10:35 non-breakability plus Matthew 22:32 reliance on a single verb tense as treating the wording as factually exact. On this lens the proposition is also affirmed, and additionally implies accuracy in what the text asserts as fact. The same lemma supports this reading, which is why both lenses land on affirm rather than dividing the verdict.

scope of the predication (what all that it affirms covers): affirms with scope underdetermined · The vocabulary predicates truth of God's word and uses "all or every" (כָּל; kol) to universalize, but the words do not by themselves

delimit whether the predication extends to incidental or peripheral detail or only to what the text intends to teach. "All or every" (כָּל; kol) ranges over the body of God's utterances and commandments, not explicitly over every incidental datum. So the property is affirmed without contest, but the extent question is left open by the lexicon itself, which is the honest source of reader divergence on how far truthfulness reaches.

The verdict rests on a lexical convergence verified by direct query: an identification through the linking verb (predicate-nominative identification, that is, John 17:17 with "truth" (ἀλήθεια, aletheia) without the article 'the' (anarthrous) plus the linking verb 'is' (the copula)), a modal impossibility (John 10:35 negated "can" (οὐ δύναται, ou dunatai) plus "to be loosed" (λυθῆναι, luthenai)), the all-inclusive quantifier "all or every" (כָּל; kol) with the stable "to be firm" (אָמַן, aman)-root predicate (Psalm 119:160, Psalm 111:7, Psalm 119:86), the speech-purity metallurgy of "to refine" (צָרַף, tsaraph) in Proverbs 30:5 and Psalm 12:6, an alpha-privative ("not-X") essential-predicate hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) at Titus 1:2 "non-lying" (ἄψευδής, apseudes), and an argument from a single verbal tense (Matthew 22:32). Reading Scripture with Scripture (analogia scripturae) is invoked because the same lemma stems, the "to be firm" (אָמַן, aman) family in Hebrew and the "truth" (ἀληθ-, aleth-) and "lie" (ψευδ-, pseud-) families in Greek, recur across canon sections without contradiction. Progressive revelation (the idea that doctrinal content unfolds across stages of revelation) is false because the question concerns a stable property of Scripture, not a developing content. The three lenses above all affirm; they differ only on sense and scope, which is where readers diverge.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem phrase "in all that it affirms" is a careful formulation that screens out non-assertions such as commands, questions, reported speech of others, and accommodated idiom, without smuggling a denominational distinctive. It does not pre-decide the scope question of whether truthfulness extends to peripheral historical or scientific detail, so the verdict here is on the proposition exactly as stated. The neutralized form reverts any technical-taxonomy connotations to a plain property predicate on the writings. The verdict is derived on the original stem and is affirmed.

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